Sardar Patel Institute of Technology (SPIT)

Attendance Policy (2024-25) - Old Version

SYNTHETIC - FOR RESEARCH AND TESTING ONLY

Document control	Details
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Purpose. This archived policy describes the fictional attendance rules that applied to Academic Year 2024-25 only. It is retained to test version-aware retrieval and must not be treated as the operative 2026-27 policy.

Research-use notice. All authorities, dates, thresholds, fees, timelines and procedures in this document are invented for a synthetic research corpus. They must not be relied on for real academic, legal, financial or administrative decisions.

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1. Historical status and applicability

This document is a synthetic historical policy created for research and testing. It is not an actual SPIT policy, circular or academic record. Its provisions applied only to the fictional Academic Year 2024-25, from 15 July 2024 through 30 June 2025, unless a specific semester calendar stated a shorter teaching period.

The policy applied to full-time undergraduate and postgraduate students in regular programmes administered by the Academic Office. It covered lectures, tutorials, laboratories, studios and other scheduled instructional sessions. Programme-specific handbooks could provide additional operational detail but could not reduce the minimum attendance stated here.

For Academic Year 2026-27, this policy was superseded by SPIT-ACA-ATT-2026-27-001, published 01 July 2026 and effective 15 July 2026. The old policy must not be used to determine a student's 2026-27 eligibility, even where the student has carried forward a course or has a backlog. The current academic year of the registered course controls.

2. Definitions used in 2024-25

Term	Historical meaning
Scheduled period	A timetabled instructional period assigned to a course.
Conducted period	A period in which teaching or supervised practical work actually took place.
Theory attendance	Attendance recorded for lectures, tutorials and theory-oriented classes.
Laboratory attendance	Attendance recorded for laboratory, workshop, studio and supervised practical sessions.
Attendance shortage	A percentage below the threshold specified in Section 3.
Condonation	A discretionary relaxation considered for documented exceptional absence; it did not make the student present in the register.

In the historical system, teaching staff used a department-maintained attendance register. A course's attendance percentage was computed from conducted periods, not from the originally published timetable alone. Sessions formally cancelled and not replaced were omitted.

3. Minimum attendance standard

The historical minimum was 75% in each course. A practical or laboratory component also carried a 75% minimum. Where a course contained theory and practical work, the department reported a combined course percentage and a practical component percentage; both had to be at least 75%.

Course type	Minimum during 2024-25	Historical interpretation
Theory-only	75%	At least three quarters of conducted theory periods.
Practical-only	75%	At least three quarters of conducted practical sessions.
Combined theory and practical	75% overall and 75% practical	Both recorded figures had to meet 75%.
Tutorial / studio	75%	Counted in the component to which the department assigned the class.

The percentage was calculated as periods attended divided by periods conducted, multiplied by 100. The department displayed a whole-number percentage on some paper registers; where a value fell on a boundary, the underlying count was used. A student could not transfer attendance from one course to another.

Unlike the 2026-27 policy, this historical policy did not impose an 80% minimum for practical work. The 75% practical threshold in this document is deliberately retained as a version-conflict test case.

4. Recording procedure

The instructor recorded attendance at the beginning of a class or at the point designated by the department. The register was submitted to the course coordinator at the end of each month. Departments were expected to update the consolidated attendance sheet at least once in a month, subject to practical constraints.

A student who arrived after attendance had been taken could request the instructor to verify presence before the end of the class. The instructor was not required to change a completed entry without supporting information. A correction had to be initialled by the instructor and countersigned by the course coordinator.

The paper register or department-approved spreadsheet was the primary record. This historical policy did not require the central digital attendance portal or a 48-hour upload target. A later digitisation initiative was not to be applied retrospectively to this document.

The department displayed monthly attendance summaries on the department notice board or circulated them through the approved student communication channel. Students were expected to inspect the summary and report discrepancies promptly.

5. Leave and absence

A student who missed a scheduled class was marked absent unless the instructor verified that the student had attended. Medical leave, personal leave, travel, participation in an outside competition or an approved department activity did not automatically count as attendance.

A student participating in an officially approved academic event could submit the duty order or participation confirmation when applying for condonation. The event was treated as a reason for absence, not as automatic attendance credit. This historical position is different from the limited deemed-attendance credit introduced for qualifying institutional duty in the 2026-27 Revised Attendance Circular.

A student who was absent for a prolonged period was expected to notify the class advisor or Head of Department as early as practicable. Notification was not itself an approval of attendance or an exemption from the minimum requirement.

6. Historical condonation route

A student whose attendance was between 65% and 74.99% in a course could submit a condonation request for documented exceptional circumstances. The same 65%-74.99% range applied to theory and practical components. A student below 65% in any required component was not eligible for condonation under this policy.

The maximum adjustment was ten percentage points, and the student had to reach at least 75% after the approved adjustment. The adjustment was not automatic. A student at 70% could receive no more than five percentage points if that was sufficient to reach 75%; a student at 64.99% could not be raised into the eligible range.

The student submitted a written request to the Head of Department within ten working days after returning to classes. Supporting documents could include a medical certificate, hospital discharge summary, official event duty order or other evidence accepted by the department. The department forwarded its recommendation to the Academic Office.

The historical policy did not contain the component-specific 70% non-condonable practical floor introduced in 2026-27, nor did it use the central digital application route described in SPIT-ACA-CND-2026-27-001. This section must not be substituted for the current condonation rules.

7. Examination eligibility

At the end of the semester, the department prepared a list of students whose course attendance was at least 75%, or whose condonation request had been approved. The list was forwarded to the examination office for use in preparation of the examination roll.

A student below 75% without approved condonation could be withheld from the examination in the affected course. Attendance eligibility was course-specific. Payment of an examination fee did not override a department's eligibility finding.

The historical document did not prescribe the 2026-27 examination registration windows, payment amounts, online form correction period or attendance snapshot dates. Those later procedures are documented separately in SPIT-EXM-REG-2026-27-001.

8. Review and correction of historical records

A student who found a discrepancy in the monthly summary was expected to approach the course instructor or class advisor within seven calendar days of the summary being displayed. The student identified the date and class and supplied any available proof. The instructor checked the register and submitted a correction note to the Head of Department.

The department retained the corrected sheet with the original record. A correction was not permitted merely because a student's percentage was close to 75%. Attendance was a record of participation, not a discretionary rounding exercise.

For the synthetic 2024-25 version, the seven-calendar-day review period is distinct from the five-working-day period in the original 2026-27 policy and the seven-working-day period introduced by the 2026-27 circular. These periods belong to different versions and must not be mixed.

9. Responsibilities and record retention

The course instructor was responsible for the original class register. The class advisor monitored overall attendance. The Head of Department reviewed exceptional cases and certified the semester statement. The Academic Office maintained the consolidated record received from departments.

Departments retained attendance sheets and approved condonation notes for at least two academic years after the semester. Access was limited to the student concerned, the assigned teaching staff, the department and authorised academic administrators.

10. Supersession and historical interpretation

Document SPIT-ACA-ATT-2024-25-001, Version 1.0, was effective 15 July 2024 and is superseded for Academic Year 2026-27 by SPIT-ACA-ATT-2026-27-001, Version 1.0, effective 15 July 2026.

Material changes introduced in 2026-27 include: (a) the practical minimum increased from 75% to 80%; (b) a separate non-condonable practical floor of 70% was introduced; (c) attendance recording moved to the central portal with a 48-hour instructor submission target; (d) monthly-statement disputes moved to a five-working-day window, later amended to seven working days for qualifying statements by SPIT-ACA-CIR-2026-27-003; and (e) a formal digital condonation process was established.

The archived policy is retained to support historical questions such as "What was the practical attendance minimum in 2024-25?" It is not evidence of the current rule. A chatbot must identify the academic year before applying the threshold.

Appendix A. Historical examples

Question context	Correct historical answer
A student attended 15 of 20 practical sessions in 2024-25.	75%; the student met the historical practical minimum.
A student attended 15 of 20 practical sessions in 2026-27.	This old document does not apply; the current minimum is 80% under SPIT-ACA-ATT-2026-27-001.
A 2024-25 student had 64% attendance.	Below the historical 65% condonation floor; not eligible under this version.
A student asks whether old rules apply to a 2026-27 backlog course.	Use the current rules applicable to the academic year in which the course is registered and assessed, as specified by the Academic Office.

Appendix B. Related documents

Document ID	Title	How to use
SPIT-ACA-ATT-2026-27-001	Attendance Policy (2026-27)	Current base policy; supersedes this document for 2026-27.
SPIT-ACA-CND-2026-27-001	Attendance Condonation Rules	Current condonation procedure; do not substitute the historical route.
SPIT-ACA-CIR-2026-27-003	Revised Attendance Circular (2026-27)	Later amendment effective 01 Jan 2027.

END OF SYNTHETIC DOCUMENT